Full Marks for Performance

Upma Chaturvedi, *55*
Lucknow, *Professor, Geography, Avadh Girls' Degree College, Lucknow*

Constituency: Lucknow

Issues that will decide her vote: Infrastructure development, women empowerment and anti-corruption initiatives

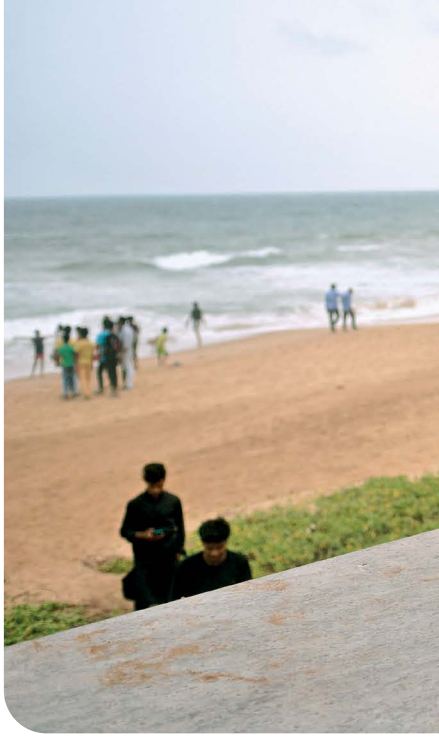
Geography teacher Prof. Upma Chaturvedi keeps a keen eye on the electoral landscape of the country. She is pleased that the ruling BJP government has placed a strong emphasis on infrastructure development and women's empowerment in recent years. According to her, the building of a network of highways and new roads has significantly eased travel across the state. Women's safety too has improved. "The government has taken decisive actions to address the issue. This has instilled a sense of security among my students, which is significant from an educator's perspective."

Chaturvedi also appreciates the construction of the Ram temple in Ayodhya, confident that developments like these are likely to influence the voting decisions of the women in her state. ■

-Prashant Srivastava



SUMIT KUMAR



A WOMEN-

Malla Devi Visalakshi takes a special interest in politics as "it is the best mode to serve the people on a mass scale". The interior designer is not aware of how Viksit Bharat, Ujjwala, Har Ghar Jal, Lakhpati Didi and other Union government schemes are changing women's lives but hopes the government devises programmes that can help make women independent.

"Women's decisions can steer more people towards

Good Intent Is Not Enough

In July 2021, Reyman Jangde was elected sarpanch of her village in a keenly contested poll. However, this wasn't her maiden foray into village-level politics. She and her husband Yashwant, a farmer, had been panch between 2010 and 2015, and hence well aware of grassroots issues.

"I will vote for the BJP because of the numerous works done in the last two terms," says Reyman, listing the Jan Dhan and Ujjwala schemes and the Women's Reservation Act as

Reyman Jangde, *40*
Sankara, Chhattisgarh
Sarpanch, works for an SHG

Constituency: Durg

Issues that will decide her vote: Jan Dhan and Ujjwala schemes; women's quota

Demands from the govt: Better execution of Ayushman Bharat and job quotas for locals



BHUPESH KESHARWANI